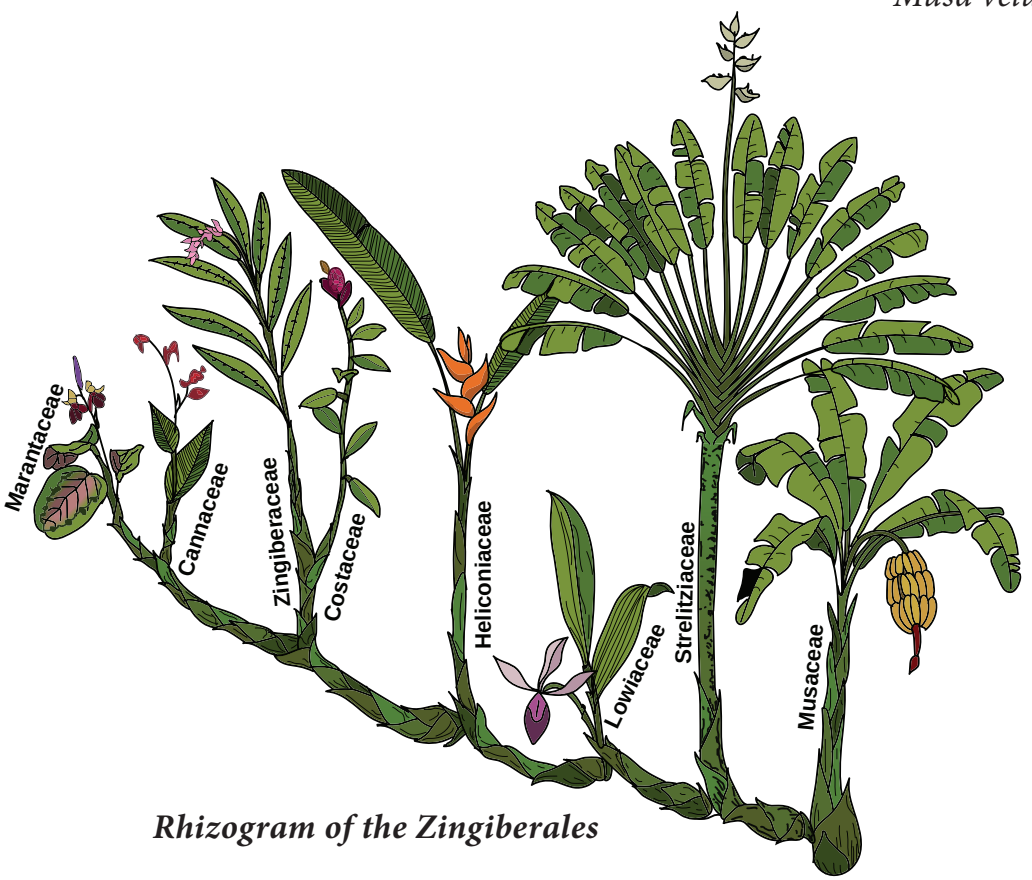
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**Systematic Position**

| APG Classification | | Bentham and Hooker Classification | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kingdom | Plantae | Kingdom | Plantae |
| *Clade* | Angiosperms | Class: | Monocotyledonae |
| *Clade* | Monocots | Subclass | Zingiberidae |
| *Clade* | Commelinids | Series | Epigynae |
| Order | Zingiberales | Order | Zingiberales |
| Family | Musaceae | Family | Musaceae |



*Musa velutina*




***Rhizogram of the Zingiberales***

Note: Earlier Musaceae was a large family with 6 genera viz. *Musa, Ensete, Ravenala, Strelitzia, Orchidantha* and *Heliconia*. In APG only Musa and Ensete are retained while *Ravenala, Strelitzia, Orchidantha* and *Heleconia* are separated.

**General Characters**

**Distribution**

Musaceae includes only 2 genera (*Musa* and *Ensete*) and 81 species. The members of this family are mainly wet tropical lowlands from West Africa to Pacific (southern Japan to Queensland). (*Musa* is the most common plant of the family found in India)

**Habit:** Large perennial herbs perennating by means of rhizome ( *Musa paradisiaca*), raraly trees as in *Ravenala madagascariensis*.

**Root:** Fibrous adventitious root system.

**Stem:** In *Musa* the real stem is found underground called rhizomatous (dichotomously branching in atleast